Home Underwriting Guide

Version 2026.1 (UK) - effective from 01 April 2026 - reference JIG-UW-HOME-2026.1

Purpose and authority

This guide sets out the acceptance criteria, referral points and rating loads for Jigsaw Home Insurance (wording 2026.1, UK). It is for use by Jigsaw underwriting staff only and must not be shared with customers or brokers. Where a risk falls outside this guide, refer it before quoting.

Underwriting authority levels

Role	Maximum buildings sum insured	Maximum contents sum insured	Can accept referred risks
Underwriter	£750,000	£100,000	No
Senior underwriter	£1,000,000	£150,000	Yes, except declines
Underwriting manager	£2,500,000	£250,000	Yes

Any risk with a buildings sum insured above £2,500,000 must be referred to the Head of Personal Lines Underwriting.

Acceptance criteria

Construction

Standard construction is brick, stone or concrete walls with a roof of slate, tile, concrete or metal. Non-standard construction is treated as follows:

Construction	Decision
Timber frame with brick outer skin	Accept at standard rates
Flat roof covering up to 25% of the total roof area	Accept at standard rates
Flat roof covering more than 25% of the total roof area	Refer to a senior underwriter
Thatched roof	Refer to a senior underwriter; apply a 35% load if accepted
Prefabricated or system-built concrete	Refer; require a structural survey
Wholly timber or mobile homes	Decline

Listed buildings

Grade II listed (or category B or C in Scotland) properties can be accepted with a 15% load on the buildings premium. Grade I and Grade II* listed properties (or category A in Scotland) must be referred to the underwriting manager.

Subsidence history

If the property has suffered subsidence in the last 10 years, or is within 50 metres of a property that has, refer to a senior underwriter. We will only consider acceptance if a structural engineer's report confirms that the property has been stable for at least 3 years after repairs. Accepted risks carry a subsidence excess of £2,500.

Flood risk

Properties in a high flood risk area, or that have flooded in the last 25 years, must be referred. Properties built after 1 January 2009 are not eligible for the Flood Re scheme and should be quoted at full flood rates or declined.

Occupancy

Occupancy	Decision
Owner occupied, main residence	Accept
Let to a single family on an assured shorthold tenancy	Decline - refer to Jigsaw Landlord product
Holiday home or second home	Refer; unoccupancy conditions apply
Unoccupied for more than 30 days at inception	Refer to a senior underwriter
Business use beyond clerical work, or visitors to the home for business	Refer

Rating loads and discounts

Claims history (last 5 years)

Number of claims	Action
None	10% claims-free discount
1 claim	No load
2 claims	25% load on the affected section
3 or more claims	Refer to a senior underwriter
Any escape of water claim over £10,000	Apply endorsement HE12 at renewal

Security

Valuables over £20,000 in total require an intruder alarm installed to a recognised standard. Valuables over £50,000 in total, or any single item over £15,000, must be referred and may require a safe.

Convictions

Any unspent criminal conviction (other than a motoring offence) for anyone living at the home must be referred. Convictions for arson, burglary, theft or fraud in the last 5 years result in a decline.

Referrals

Refer risks using the underwriting referral queue in the policy administration system. Senior underwriters aim to respond to referrals within 1 working day. Quotes for referred risks are valid for 30 days.